
Payment problems worth solving

Field research into how money actually breaks — for people and for AI agents — and what Evabob should build next.

Prepared for the Evabob team

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Scope human payments · agent payments · product roadmap

Sources 60+ primary and secondary, plus 30 social posts, gathered 17–18 September 2026

Evabob is a testnet integration showcase today: it has never held real value and has no users. Every product claim in this report is measured against `docs/STATUS.md`, not against marketing copy.

The gap is trust, not rails

Moving money is close to solved. Stablecoin rails settle in under a second and Arc's mainnet went live two days ago. What is not solved — for a market trader in Lagos and for an autonomous research agent alike — is **knowing that the other side will hold up their end**, and being able to undo it when they don't. That is the gap Evabob is already built against, and it is where every recommendation here points.

90%

of Zelle scam claims went unrefunded in the cases studied — authorised push payments are final²⁶

82%

of remittance recipients hit at least one problem with delay, charges or uncertainty (10 countries, n=6,763)⁴¹

23%

of US adults would trust an AI to execute a payment, though 72% have used one⁹

35 of 37

completed agent-posted bounties where the human worker was never paid²³

Seven findings that should shape the product

1. **Every incumbent rail fails at the same moment: after the money leaves.** Push payments (Zelle, Venmo, bank transfer, and stablecoin sends) are irreversible by design; cards are reversible but merchants eat \$5.13 of cost for every \$1 disputed.⁵⁶ Evabob already holds money in a contract until a condition is met. That primitive — not the chat UI — is the moat.
2. **Chat is where commerce happens, and it is where the trust hole is.** 95–97% of smartphone users in Nigeria, Ghana and Kenya are on WhatsApp; Africa's social commerce market is put at \$33.7bn for 2026.³¹ Sellers demand payment before delivery, buyers get blocked after paying, and both sides know it.^{29,30}
3. **"Proof of payment" is broken, and Evabob can fix it for free.** Fake bank-alert screenshots are an industry in Nigeria — with apps sold purely to fabricate them.³² Evabob verifies settlement on chain before it writes a receipt. A shareable, verifiable "Paid ✓" page is a few days of work and solves a daily problem for every small vendor.
4. **Money in limbo is as painful as money lost.** On 26 May 2026 Nigeria's inter-bank switch failed for about ten hours on the eve of Eid: senders were debited, recipients credited nothing, and nothing reversed.³³ Evabob's settlement is atomic — that is a marketing claim it can actually keep, provided bridge and Gateway flows stop stranding value.
5. **Agents don't need payment rails; they need brakes, receipts and refunds.** x402 has processed 165m+ transactions across ~69,000 agents, but roughly half the volume looks like testing, not commerce.⁴ The unsolved layer is metering, budget enforcement, reconciliation and dispute evidence.⁵ Evabob's agent wallets already have per-call and daily caps, key rotation and durable reservations — ahead of most of the market.
6. **What consumers say they need before delegating spend is exactly what Evabob shipped:** spending caps (30%), instant revocation (29%), easy cancellation (28%).¹⁰ The product should say this in those words.
7. **Nobody owns "agents and humans paying each other."** Stripe, Visa and Mastercard are building agent-to-merchant. x402 is agent-to-API. Agent-to-human is a documented disaster today (workers ghosted after delivering work²³), and human-to-agent is unbuilt. Evabob has both halves already — identities for people, wallets for agents, and an escrow contract between them.

What we recommend, in one paragraph

Keep the held-payment contract, name-based identity and capped agent wallets — they are the assets. Fix the three things that currently break the promise: no notification when the app is closed, a job hold that returns money to the payer when the payer simply goes quiet, and money that can strand mid-bridge. Then ship four things in order: (1) **verifiable "Paid ✓" receipts and a vendor view**, (2) **hold-until-delivered payment links for chat commerce**, (3) **an agent allowance with risk-tiered approvals and a loop breaker**, and (4) **pre-funded bounties so an agent can hire a human without ghosting them**. Everything else in Section 8 is optional; those four are the product.

How this was researched, and what it can't see

Between 17 and 18 September 2026 we ran roughly sixty web searches and source fetches across news, primary company announcements, regulator and World Bank data, academic preprints, developer forums, review platforms and market research, then cross-checked each number against the page that published it rather than the search snippet. A second pass of about thirty searches then went after social posts directly (Section 10).

What we could read

- **Primary announcements:** Circle (Arc mainnet, Agent Stack), Stripe/Tempo (MPP), Ethereum EIP registry (ERC-8004), IRS, PSR.
- **Data and research:** World Bank Remittance Prices Worldwide, Chainalysis, Thunes/Juniper (n=6,763 across ten countries), Harris Poll for Visa (n=2,065), Checkout.com, Accenture, two arXiv preprints on x402 attacks and on agent-to-human marketplaces.
- **Unfiltered user voice:** Trustpilot reviews from the last six weeks for Chipper Cash, Payoneer, Grey, Cash App and LemFi; Hacker News threads on x402; Shopify and OpenAI community forums; DEV.to post-mortems of runaway agent bills; Nigerian outlets (FIJ, Legit.ng, TechCabal, BusinessDay) that quote viral posts verbatim.

What we could not read — stated plainly

Reddit blocks our crawler outright. Direct fetches and domain-restricted searches were refused, and a re-test on 18 September got the same result. It is the one blind spot this report could not work around. X returns `HTTP 402 Payment Required` when a post is opened, which is an apt failure for a report on agent payments. Instagram and Facebook pages can't be opened either.

A second pass found a partial way in. Search engines index the text of public posts on X and Facebook, so we collected 30 dated posts from that index. They are in Section 10 and quoted exactly as indexed. We could not open them, so we have no replies, context or engagement counts. **No finding in Sections 4–9 depends on them.** They confirm those findings and add one new fact. Elsewhere, social sentiment comes through three other sources: Trustpilot and vendor forums (unfiltered, dated, attributable), Nigerian journalism that quotes named posts with dates, and survey research that sampled the same populations. Where a claim is weaker than we'd like, the report says so.

Two consequences worth holding: we are still likely under-weighting very recent, very local complaints that live in Reddit threads and Instagram comments; and consumer-app review platforms over-represent angry users by construction. The survey data is the counterweight.

How Evabob's own state was established

From the repository, not from memory: `docs/STATUS.md` (last verified 2026-09-13), `contracts/src/PaymentEscrowV2.sol`, the server routes under `server/src/routes/` and the Flutter feature tree. Where this report says a flow "works", it means implemented and exercised by hand on testnet — never in production, and never with real money.

The market as of this week

Three things changed in the last four months that matter more to Evabob than anything in the preceding two years: the settlement chain it already targets went to mainnet, the agent-payment protocol war produced a clear split between "checkout" and "machine payments", and the first consumer research arrived showing precisely which controls people demand before they let software spend.

3.1 Arc is no longer a testnet story

Arc mainnet launched on 16 September 2026 — two days ago — with BlackRock, DTCC, Galaxy, ICE, Mastercard, MoneyGram, SBI, Standard Chartered, Sumitomo, Visa and Worldpay as founding validators, 100+ applications live on day one, and a testnet that had processed 700m+ transactions in under a year. Gas is paid in USDC, finality is sub-second, confidential transactions with view keys are opt-in, and the launch explicitly ships **Agent Wallets, nanopayments via Gateway, and an Arc Portal for funding wallets, setting spend limits and delegating tasks**. Circle states USDC accounts for 98.8% of agent-driven transaction volume to date.¹

Read against Evabob's architecture, this is unusually good news: the chain, the gas model, the wallet model and the nanopayment rail Evabob already builds on are now production infrastructure with the card networks as validators. It also means the "testnet showcase" framing has an expiry date — the interesting question is no longer whether the rails work.

3.2 The agent-payment stack split into layers

STANDARD	OWNER / DATE	WHAT IT ACTUALLY DOES
x402	Coinbase → Linux Foundation, Apr 2026	HTTP 402 handshake; agent pays stablecoin per request. 165m+ transactions, ~69,000 agents, ~\$50m cumulative, average payment \$0.20–\$0.30 — and roughly half the volume looks like testing. ^{3,4}
MPP	Stripe + Tempo, 18 Mar 2026	"Sessions": deposit into escrow, authorise e.g. "\$50 over 2 hours", stream micropayments, settle once. OAuth-for-money. ¹⁷
ACP	OpenAI + Stripe	In-chat checkout. Instant Checkout was pulled back in March 2026 after Walmart measured ~3× worse conversion than a click-through. ¹⁶
AP2	Google, now FIDO-governed	Consent layer: cryptographically signed intent and cart mandates proving a human authorised the agent. ¹⁸
TAP / Agent Pay	Visa, Mastercard, 2026	Network-level agent credentials and "verifiable intent" on card rails. ⁵⁸
ERC-8004	Ethereum mainnet, 29 Jan 2026	Agent identity, reputation and validation registries — the "know your agent" layer. ¹⁹

The lesson from ACP's retreat is the most useful one: the thing that failed was not agent payment, it was agents doing checkout with stale data and unclear delivery and tax. Discovery in the assistant, payment somewhere accountable. That argues for Evabob being the accountable place a payment lands and is approved — not for Evabob trying to be a shopping agent.

3.3 Consumers have already told us the price of trust

What consumers say they need before letting an AI agent spend



Share of consumers naming each safeguard as essential before delegating purchases to an AI agent. Source: Checkout.com, *Agentic Commerce 2026*, June 2026.¹⁰ Evabob's agent wallets already implement all three: per-call and daily caps, `POST /v1/agents/:id/revoke`, and key rotation.

Alongside that: only 23% of US adults would trust generative AI to execute a payment, against 72% who have used an AI assistant;⁹ 39% trust agents for everyday purchases and 34% for larger items;¹¹ just 9% would let an agent buy fully autonomously;¹² and 24% say they will never delegate purchases at all.¹⁰ Meanwhile 89% of merchants are preparing for agentic commerce and only ~3% of transactions involve agents today.¹⁰ The demand is real; the trust is the bottleneck; the controls are the product.

3.4 Regulation, briefly, because it constrains the roadmap

- **Nigeria, August 2026:** a regulatory consortium (CBN, SEC, NRS, NFIU, ONSA); SEC minimum capital of ₦2bn for exchanges and custodians, ₦300m for ancillary providers; a 1.5% stamp duty on crypto-to-fiat conversions; the CBN sandbox opened to virtual-asset firms; CARF reporting committed by 2028. Personal wallet transfers and holding remain non-taxable events.⁵² **Implication:** a wallet-to-wallet Evabob is a lighter regulatory object than an Evabob with naira cash-in/cash-out — and cash-in/out is exactly what users need. That trade-off deserves an explicit decision, early.
- **United States, since 1 January 2026:** a 1% excise tax on remittance transfers funded with cash or money orders — explicitly **not** applicable to stablecoin or virtual-currency transfers.⁵³ A structural pricing advantage for the diaspora corridor, and a legitimate marketing line.
- **Demand context:** Sub-Saharan Africa took in \$205bn+ of on-chain value in the year to June 2025, up ~52%; Nigeria alone \$92.1bn and #2 globally for grassroots adoption; stablecoins are 43% of regional volume.⁵¹

Ten ways money breaks for people

Each problem below carries the evidence we found, an honest assessment of how well Evabob's current build addresses it, and what is missing. The fit rating is our judgement, not a measurement.

H1 The payment can't be taken back — and everyone knows it but the victim

Partial fit

EVIDENCE

- Once accepted, Zelle, Cash App and Venmo payments cannot be reversed; banks reimbursed in roughly **10% of cases** where customers were tricked.²⁶
- UK APP fraud: **£576.4m** lost in 2025; mandatory reimbursement has pushed in-scope repayment to 97% and cut losses ~£73m/yr — regulators now treat irreversibility as a market failure.²⁷
- Voice-cloned "family emergency" calls are the fastest-growing fraud against over-50s; a 3-second clip is enough, and scammers always steer to irreversible rails.²⁸

WHERE EVABOB STANDS

- Asset:** `PaymentEscrowV2` can hold a payment instead of sending it, and refund only ever pays the original funder.
- Gap:** a normal send is as final as Zelle. There is no first-time-payee warning, no cooling-off, no name confirmation step.
- Gap:** stablecoin finality means Evabob inherits the whole problem class unless it deliberately designs against it.

Opportunity: make "hold it for ten minutes" the default for a first payment to a new person, and let the sender cancel from the receipt. Evabob is one of very few apps that can offer undo without asking anyone's permission, because the money sits in a contract rather than in a recipient's account.

H2 Pay first, hope later: the chat-commerce trust hole

Strong fit

EVIDENCE

- A documented case: an Abuja buyer paid an Instagram vendor **₦154,000** for ten items and was blocked before delivery.²⁹
- The published advice is now "never pay 100% upfront — use a deposit, a milestone, then the balance on delivery," and to treat refusal of any protected method as a red flag.³⁰
- Scale: 95–97% of smartphone users in Nigeria, Ghana and Kenya are on WhatsApp; Africa's social commerce market is projected at **\$33.7bn in 2026**.³¹

WHERE EVABOB STANDS

- Asset:** invoice settlement already offers pay-all-now, **half now / half held**, or **all held until delivered** — on chain, with the payer as the on-chain sender.
- Asset:** public pay pages at `/pay/{requestId}` mean the buyer needs no account to start.
- Gap:** it lives inside Evabob chat. The commerce happens in WhatsApp and Instagram DMs, and WhatsApp invites are a stub.

Opportunity — highest-conviction in this report: a hold-until-delivered link a seller can paste into any DM or bio. The buyer's money leaves their wallet (so the seller sees commitment) but the seller can't touch it until delivery is confirmed or the window closes. This is the exact instrument both sides are already improvising with deposits.

H3 "I've sent it" — the fake alert economy

Strong fit

EVIDENCE

- Apps exist purely to fabricate bank alerts: a sender name, account number, amount, reference and date, with no money moving. Cloned bank interfaces that show a "successful transfer" screen offline are an expected 2026–27 escalation.³²
- "Fake alert transfer app" is a standing search category on TikTok in Nigeria — supply, not just demand.³²
- The only accepted defence in circulation is manual: check your own banking app before releasing goods.³²

WHERE EVABOB STANDS

- **Asset:** settlement evidence is verified on chain — exact sender, recipient, token and amount, with replay rejected — before a receipt exists.
- **Asset:** inbound alerts already fire in real time over Pusher.
- **Gap:** alerts don't arrive when the app is force-quit, and there is no third-party-verifiable receipt a seller can check independently.

Opportunity: a "Paid ✓" page anyone can open — amount, who, when, and the on-chain proof — plus a seller view that shows incoming payments as they land. A screenshot can be faked; a link that the buyer cannot forge cannot. Cheap to build, and it is the kind of feature a market trader tells another market trader about.

H4 Money in limbo: debited, not credited, not reversed

Partial fit

EVIDENCE

- **26 May 2026**, eve of Eid al-Adha: Nigeria's inter-bank switch failed for around ten hours. Senders were debited; recipients received nothing; nothing reversed.³³
- Named posts from that day: *"Three bank apps, two reversals and 20 minutes later before I could pay"*; *"Beneficiaries are not receiving inflows. Not this holiday!"*³³
- Systemic, not one-off: a ₦13.66bn switch error still in litigation years later.³⁴
- Cross-border version: 42% of remittance users report stress from lack of speed and transparency; 33% borrowed short-term to cover the gap.⁴¹

WHERE EVABOB STANDS

- **Asset:** a same-chain send on Arc either settles or doesn't — sub-second, and the memo is written atomically with the transfer.
- **Risk:** Evabob's own limbo is the bridge. Mint on Base Sepolia is blocked on ops-wallet gas, and the flow was declared "working" four times in August.
- **Gap:** the Gateway unified-balance UI is paused; deposits credit after a delay plus polling.

Opportunity: "your money is never stuck" is a claim worth the engineering. That means finishing the abandoned-bridge rule (user has ~20 minutes, then the server completes the mint at twice the gas cost), and giving every payment a shareable status link so the recipient can see *Sending* → *On the way* → *Done* without asking.

H5 The money is in the app and the app won't let go

Strong fit

EVIDENCE — RECENT REVIEWS, VERBATIM

- Chipper Cash, 1.3/5 across 395 reviews: *"Once you deposit your money with them, it is no longer yours"* (2 Aug 2026); *"Money is trapped... error messages for months"* (11 Sep 2026).³⁵
- Payoneer: account lockouts and verification loops — *"closed my account and hold my funds for no reason"* (13 Sep 2026); a survey *"under review since March 2024"*.³⁶
- Grey: *"reversed the €720 I received... you guys let me lose the money"* (8 Sep 2026).³⁷
- PayPal holds run to 21 days routinely and up to 180 days in dispute; sellers describe months to resolve.³⁹

WHERE EVABOB STANDS

- **Asset:** user-controlled wallets. Evabob cannot freeze a balance it does not custody, and that is a genuine, checkable differentiator.
- **Caveat:** the moment fiat on/off ramps and a licence arrive, the freeze problem arrives with them. Design the policy before the pressure.
- **Gap:** without any cash-out, "we never freeze your money" is technically true and practically incomplete.

Opportunity: make non-custody legible — "this is your account; we can't hold it" — and publish the precise, short list of circumstances in which anything is ever paused. Every competitor in the review excerpts above has taught this market to expect the opposite.

H6

Cross-border cost and, worse, cross-border opacity

Partial fit

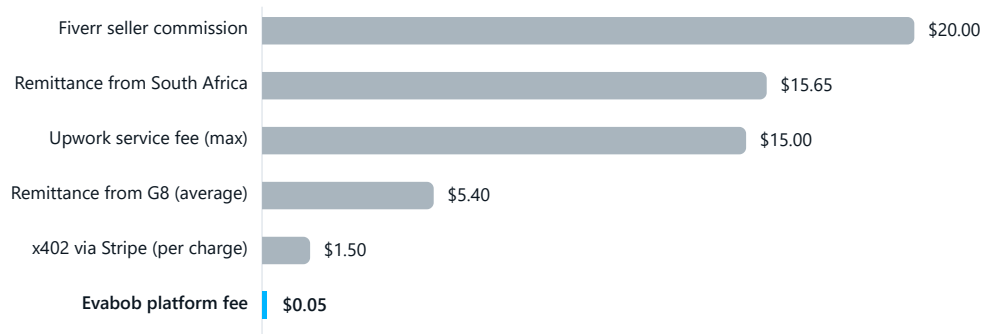
EVIDENCE

- Sending from G8 countries averaged 5.40% in Q3 2025; from South Africa, 15.65%.⁴⁰
- 41% of users received a different final amount than expected; 49% of 18–24s said there was no clear upfront view of total cost (n=6,763, ten countries).⁴¹
- 82% hit at least one problem with delays, charges or uncertainty; 23% reported strained relationships as a result.⁴¹

WHERE EVABOB STANDS

- **Asset:** a 0.05% platform fee, gas excluded — two orders of magnitude below the corridor average.
- **Asset:** users think in local currency while settlement runs in dollars.
- **Gap:** without an off-ramp, the last mile (dollars → naira in a bank account) is not priced, so the comparison is not yet apples to apples. Say so honestly in marketing.

What it costs to move \$100



Not like-for-like, deliberately: these are the different tolls the same \$100 pays depending on who moves it. Evabob's figure is the platform fee only — network gas (paid in USDC on Arc) is excluded, and Evabob has no cash-in or cash-out leg yet, which is where incumbent cost concentrates. Sources: World Bank RPW Q3 2025⁴⁰, published platform fee schedules⁴⁷, Stripe x402 pricing⁴, Evabob PLATFORM_FEE_BPS=5.

H7

Having dollars and still not being able to spend them

Gap

EVIDENCE

- Nigerian bank cards, including domiciliary cards, are unreliable internationally — declined by Netflix, rejected by AWS, blocked by Google Ads.⁴²
- The virtual-dollar-card workaround keeps collapsing: Union54's halt took down issuance at several fintechs; chargeback fraud and declines drove others to pause or charge for failures.⁴³
- Developers describe being unable to pay for the OpenAI API from Nigeria at all.⁴⁴
- PayPal has only just returned to Nigeria for inbound payments via a Paga partnership — two decades late and receive-only.⁴⁵

WHERE EVABOB STANDS

- **Nothing here yet.** The knowledge base correctly tells users Evabob has no card or bank top-up.
- This is the single most-requested capability adjacent to Evabob's user base, and the one with the worst provider track record.

Opportunity, with a warning: a USD card funded from an Evabob balance would be the strongest acquisition hook available — and card programmes for this market have a documented history of sudden shutdowns. If it ships, it ships through a licensed partner, with balances outside the card programme and an explicit "your money stays yours if the card stops" guarantee. There is a cheaper first step: let an agent pay for the subscription (see A9).

H8 Freelancers do the work and then chase the money

Partial fit

EVIDENCE

- Industry compilations put late payment at ~85% of freelancers affected, ~29–33% of invoices paid late, an average \$6,000 owed, over a full working day a month spent chasing, and 42% missing personal bills because of it.⁴⁶
(Aggregated vendor statistics — directionally reliable, individually soft.)
- The alternative is a platform that takes 0–15% (Upwork) or a flat 20% (Fiverr), plus payout holds.⁴⁷

WHERE EVABOB STANDS

- **Asset:** invoice holds on chain, 90-day default, up to 365 days; half-now/half-held; the payer funds the contract directly.
- **Serious gap:** a job hold releases only when the payer confirms delivery. If the payer goes quiet, the hold expires and **refunds to the payer**. The freelancer did the work and carries all the risk — the protection currently runs one way.
- **Gap:** no dispute path, no reminders, no milestones.

Opportunity: add "delivered — releases automatically in N days unless the payer disputes", with evidence attached to the dispute. That single change converts the escrow from payer-protection into two-sided protection, which is what makes it worth choosing over a 20% platform.

H9 Group money with no trustworthy holder

Partial fit

EVIDENCE

- Rotating savings (ajo/esusu) runs on a collector who physically holds the pot — "*the ajo collector ran away with our money*" is a loss story millions know first-hand. A documented case: ₦1,000/day for six months, then the collector vanished with her savings and several others'.⁴⁸
- Diaspora support ("black tax") fails structurally, not culturally: reactive crisis transfers, no schedule, no cap, no visibility of what the money did — which is what breeds resentment on both sides.⁴⁹
- Bill-splitting apps exist in volume precisely because asking friends for money is socially expensive.

WHERE EVABOB STANDS

- **Asset:** a deployed escrow contract, identities by email/handle, and chat threads — the three ingredients of a pot that nobody personally holds.
- **Gap:** no group construct at all — no shared pot, no scheduled contribution, no payout order, no progress visible to members.

Opportunity: savings circles and group pots where the contract is the collector. This is a large, culturally-native market that fintechs have mostly digitised without removing the trust hole.

H10 The crypto-native traps Evabob must keep hiding

Strong fit

EVIDENCE

- Wrong-network sends are the most common and most costly stablecoin mistake — addresses look identical across EVM chains.⁵⁰
- Address poisoning: 2,000,000 USDC sent to an address matching the real one in 7 of 40 characters; a separate case lost nearly \$50m.⁵⁰

WHERE EVABOB STANDS

- **Asset:** payees are an email, an @handle or an address — resolved through an on-chain registry, so the common case never involves a hex string.
- **Asset:** home shows one total; networks live behind a tap; jargon is banned in user-facing copy.
- **Gap:** raw 0x sends still have no "have you paid this address before?" check.

Ten ways money breaks for software

The agent-payments market is loud about rails and quiet about consequences. Almost every unresolved problem is a variant of one question: *what happens when the agent is wrong?*

A1 Runaway spend, and the metering gap nobody has closed

Strong fit

EVIDENCE

- Developer post-mortems: an agent that called the same tool 47 times took a bill from \$80 to \$400 in a day; another burned \$200 during a coffee break; agents in recursive loops have run up tens of thousands over a weekend.²²
- The structural point: a four-hour research agent may make hundreds of calls, buy datasets and pay sub-agents, and **nothing tells you whether it stayed under its \$200 ceiling** until the invoice arrives. Monthly billing is a postmortem, not a control.⁵
- Caps must be enforced below the agent, at the signing layer — application-level checks can be bypassed by a bug or an injection.⁸

WHERE EVABOB STANDS

- **Asset:** per-call cap, per-agent daily cap, and a cap across all of one user's agents — enforced server-side, plus a durable reservation before any signature.
- **Asset:** the agent key works on exactly one route (`/v1/x402/pay`) and can read nothing else.
- **Gap:** no live spend meter, no loop detection, no per-task attribution, no statement the owner can read.

Opportunity: Evabob is already past the hard part (enforced caps). The visible half — a live meter, a circuit breaker on repetition, and one readable statement per task — is what turns it into a product people trust.

A2 Prompt injection and key theft turn a wallet into a faucet

Strong fit

EVIDENCE

- Without a per-transaction cap a single successful injection drains the balance in one transaction; with a \$5 cap the attacker gets \$5. The spending policy is the difference between an incident and a catastrophe.⁸
- A malicious MCP package published to npm on 2 Aug 2026 transmitted **raw private keys** rather than signed payment authorisations; nine related packages saw 7,028 downloads. No confirmed victims — this time.⁷

WHERE EVABOB STANDS

- **Asset:** the agent never holds a key — it holds an API key that can only ask Evabob to pay, within caps, to allowlisted origins.
- **Asset:** the in-app Evabob Agent cannot move money at all: it proposes, and a human taps and enters a PIN. This is asserted by a test, not by a prompt.
- **Asset:** `/reveal-key` was removed; keys are shown once and rotated if lost.

This is Evabob's strongest existing story and it is undersold. "The agent can spend from this wallet only, never your main balance" is the sentence the market is asking for — say it on the marketing site, not just in the app.

A3 Approval fatigue: "confirm everything" is not a control

Partial fit

EVIDENCE

- Per-action approval is itself an attack surface: *"by week three approval fatigue sets in and people click approve at the speed of thought."*²¹
- For irreversible payments, showing a human a fluent proposal and asking for confirmation is rubber-stamping with extra steps — automation bias does the rest.²¹
- Consumers would let an agent spend an average of **£177** per purchase without approval — merchants assumed **£200**.¹⁰

WHERE EVABOB STANDS

- **Asset:** the confirm-card + PIN pattern exists and is proven.
- **Gap:** it's binary. Nothing runs automatically under a threshold; nothing escalates above one; and approvals cannot reach a closed app at all.

Opportunity: three tiers — silent under the user's own limit, push approval above it, hard refusal beyond the cap — plus a daily digest. Push notification delivery is the blocking dependency (see §7).

A4 Paid and not delivered: agent payments have no refund

Strong fit

EVIDENCE

- An academic evaluation of x402 found five practical attacks, measured on a live testnet: optimistic release before finality (5.18% revert-grant), settlement preemption producing paid-but-denied outcomes, replay across the HTTP-chain boundary where **one payment produced 248 grants**, proxy cache leakage exposing paid responses to unpaid clients (100%), and discovery capture where one crafted server won 71.8% of agent selections.⁶
- The protocol has no refund path. Escrow-based refund layers and machine-readable refund rules are being proposed from outside the spec; dispute-evidence extensions are open issues on the standard itself.²⁰

WHERE EVABOB STANDS

- **Asset:** an uncertain seller response is retained as **ambiguous** and surfaced to the owner — never silently refunded or retried. That is the right instinct and rarer than it sounds.
- **Asset:** idempotency keys are required, which is precisely the defence against the replay finding.
- **Gap:** when an agent pays and gets nothing, the money is gone. The escrow contract that solves this for humans is not wired to agent payments.

Opportunity: pay-after-proof for agents — hold the payment, release on a valid response, refund automatically if the seller fails. Evabob already owns the hold-and-release contract; almost nobody else in agent payments does.

A5 Nobody knows who is liable when an agent buys the wrong thing

Partial fit

EVIDENCE

- No government has enacted rules assigning liability for autonomous agent purchases; it is unclear whether an overspend is even an "unauthorised transaction". Merchants absorb it via chargebacks today.¹⁴
- *"Liability is wide open right now and being negotiated company to company."*¹³
- Amex has begun covering erroneous purchases by registered agents on its network — a partial answer that shows where this goes.¹⁵
- The strongest defence anyone has is evidence: authorisation logs, delegation records, and proof of how permissions were set.¹⁴

WHERE EVABOB STANDS

- **Asset:** every agent payment is already a durable record tied to one wallet, one owner and one set of caps.
- **Gap:** those records aren't assembled into anything a human could hand to a counterparty as evidence.

Opportunity: an exportable evidence bundle per agent payment — what the owner authorised, what was requested, what came back, hashed and timestamped. Low cost, and it is the artefact every dispute in this market will need.

A6 Agents get ghosted by nobody; humans get ghosted by agents

Strong fit

EVIDENCE

- On RentAHuman — where AI agents hire people for physical tasks, paying in stablecoins because an agent cannot hold a bank account — a study of 303 bounties over 14 days found **35 of 37 completed bounties showed zero workers paid**. Requesters extracted the work during the application stage and never accepted it.²³
- The same study documented six abuse classes, including credential farming at ~\$13 per account, and a 0.8% actual fill rate against a 97.4% nominal one.²³
- Nonetheless the direction is real: stablecoins are the only rail that lets a non-human entity pay a worker directly.²³

WHERE EVABOB STANDS

- Unique position:** Evabob has human identities (email/@handle), agent wallets, and an escrow contract between them. Nobody else has all three in one consumer app.
- Gap:** an agent wallet cannot currently fund a hold for a human worker.

Opportunity — the outlier of this report: let an agent lock the fee *before* the human starts, released on delivery. It fixes a documented, measured failure in a market that is months old, and it is a use case the card networks structurally cannot serve.

A7 You cannot tell a real agent from a hostile one

Gap

EVIDENCE

- ERC-8004 went live on Ethereum mainnet on 29 Jan 2026 with identity, reputation and validation registries, contributed to by people at MetaMask, the Ethereum Foundation, Google and Coinbase; 10,000+ agent identities registered on testnets in five months.¹⁹
- Visa's Trusted Agent Protocol and Mastercard's Agentic Tokens do the same job on card rails.⁵⁸
- Criminals hijacking legitimate agents, or standing up fraudulent ones with stolen identities, is the fraud vector professionals name first.¹³

WHERE EVABOB STANDS

- Asset:** an on-chain `IdentityRegistryV2` already maps identities to wallets, with role separation and a 2-of-3 Safe over admin.
- Gap:** agents are not identities in it. An agent is an API key and a custody address, invisible to anyone outside its owner.

Opportunity: give agents handles with visible ownership — "*Research agent · owned by @ada*" — so a human can decide whether to accept a payment or a request from one. This is the same registry, one new identity type appended (never renumbering existing ordinals).

A8 Protocol fragmentation, and demand that is thinner than the headlines

Partial fit

EVIDENCE

- Six overlapping standards in eighteen months (x402, MPP, ACP, AP2, UCP, TAP/Agent Pay), each at a different layer.¹⁸
- x402's headline numbers are real but roughly half the volume looks like testing, the average payment is \$0.20–\$0.30, and participants are overwhelmingly crypto-native.^{3,4}
- The first mass-market agent checkout was pulled back within months of launch.¹⁶

WHERE EVABOB STANDS

- Asset:** x402 support exists, fail-closed, behind an exact origin allowlist.
- Gap:** the allowlist is empty, so paid execution is off; `runParallelSources()` and `getMarketplaceServices()` are written but unwired; there is no service directory.

Recommendation: do not chase protocols. Treat x402 as today's rail, keep the seller list curated (Circle's Agent Marketplace is the obvious seed), and keep every protocol name out of the interface — the user should see "this agent can spend \$10 a day", never a standard's name.

A9 Key sprawl and stranded prepaid credits

Partial fit

EVIDENCE

- The founding argument for x402 on Hacker News was signup/KYC/key management that doesn't scale — "*Time to kill the API key.*"²⁵
- A 2026 cottage industry now exists purely to consolidate prepaid credits across providers into one balance with caps.⁵
- For users in card-declining markets (H7), pay-per-call is not a convenience — it is the only access route to paid APIs.⁴⁴

WHERE EVABOB STANDS

- **Asset:** one funded wallet, one key, hard caps — the shape the market is converging on.
- **Gap:** nothing to spend it on until the allowlist is populated.

A10 Creators are crawled, not paid

Gap

EVIDENCE

- Cloudflare Radar, June 2026 crawl-to-referral ratios: Anthropic ~4,580:1, OpenAI ~848:1, Perplexity ~186:1, Google ~5:1. More than 90% of crawled pages are unique content.²⁴
- Cloudflare now blocks mixed-use crawlers by default on ad-bearing pages and runs a pay-per-crawl programme — but it is aimed at publishers with infrastructure teams.²⁴

WHERE EVABOB STANDS

- **Gap:** Evabob only lets agents spend. Nothing lets a person get paid by one.
- **Asset:** the primitives are there — hosted public pages, identities, receipts.

Opportunity: a "get paid by agents" link — a person publishes a price for a dataset, a photo set, an hour of their time or an API, and Evabob hosts the paywall and the wallet. The individual's version of pay-per-crawl.

The outliers worth building

Every problem above is real. These are the ones where the pain is severe, the incumbents are structurally unable to fix it, and Evabob already owns most of the machinery. Scores are our assessment on a three-point scale.

OPPORTUNITY	PAIN	FREQUENCY	EVABOB FIT	INCUMBENT GAP	WHY IT IS AN OUTLIER
Hold-until-delivered links for chat commerce H2, H1	● ● ●	● ● ●	● ● ●	● ● ●	Buyers and sellers already improvise deposits and milestones by hand. The instrument exists in Evabob; it just needs to leave the app.
Verifiable "Paid ✓" receipts + seller view H3	● ● ●	● ● ●	● ● ●	● ● ●	Banks cannot prove a payment to a third party without the recipient logging in. A public, unforgeable receipt is native to how Evabob settles — and nobody is selling it.
Agent hires human, money locked first A6	● ● ●	● ● ●	● ● ●	● ● ●	A measured failure (35 of 37 bounties unpaid) in a brand-new market, on a rail card networks cannot serve. Small today, uncontested, and squarely Evabob's shape.
Agent allowance: tiers, meter, loop breaker A1, A3	● ● ●	● ● ●	● ● ●	● ● ●	The caps already exist and are enforced below the agent. The missing half is visibility — which is exactly what the surveys say buyers are waiting for.
Two-sided job escrow with auto-release H8	● ● ●	● ● ●	● ● ●	● ● ●	Correcting a live defect, not building a feature: today a silent payer gets their money back and the worker gets nothing.
Pay-after-proof for agent purchases A4	● ● ●	● ● ●	● ● ●	● ● ●	The x402 ecosystem is bolting refunds on from outside. Evabob already has the escrow contract the bolt-ons are re-implementing.
Money circles & group pots H9	● ● ●	● ● ●	● ● ●	● ● ●	Digitised ajo mostly moved the collector into an app rather than removing them. A contract that holds the pot removes the person entirely.
Get paid by agents (personal paywall) A10	● ● ●	● ● ●	● ● ●	● ● ●	Pay-per-crawl for people without infrastructure. Speculative demand, very low build cost on existing pages.
Purpose-bound family money H9	● ● ●	● ● ●	● ● ●	● ● ●	Structurally right, but needs merchant/biller integrations Evabob does not have. Park it until ramps exist.

The positioning this implies

Evabob is where money waits until the other side delivers — for people and for agents. Every incumbent is strong at sending and weak at waiting: Zelle and bank transfers cannot wait at all; cards wait but punish the merchant; freelance platforms wait and charge 10–20%; x402 does not wait at all. Evabob's escrow contract, identity registry and capped agent wallets are a waiting machine that happens to also send.

This is not a pivot. It is a reordering of what is already built, and it gives the agent and human halves of the product one shared sentence instead of two unrelated stories.

07 · ASSESSMENT

What is working, what to fix

7.1 Working — keep and lead with

CAPABILITY	WHY IT MATTERS, IN MARKET TERMS	EVIDENCE
Held payments on chain	The answer to H1, H2 and H8 simultaneously, and to A4/A6 with one adaptation. Refund only ever pays the original funder, so a sweep can never misdirect.	<code>PaymentEscrowV2</code> , 22 tests incl. a 256-run fuzz; verified on Arc end to end.
Name-based identity	Removes the entire wrong-address and address-poisoning class (H10) from the common path.	<code>IdentityRegistryV2</code> ; payees are email, @handle or 0x, nothing else.
Agent wallets with enforced caps	Matches the three safeguards consumers name as essential (caps, revocation, cancellation) and the guardrail literature's core rule: enforce below the agent.	Per-call, per-agent-daily, per-user caps; revoke/rotate; idempotency; durable pre-sign reservation.
An assistant that cannot pay	The worst outcome of a prompt-injected model is a wrong sentence, not a payment — asserted behaviourally in tests, not promised in a prompt.	<code>agentTools.test.ts</code> : propose-only, store unchanged.
Settlement verified before it is recorded	Structurally defeats fake alerts (H3) and invoice replay.	Exact sender/recipient/token/amount checked on chain; replay rejected; retired routes return 410 rather than fabricate history.
Plain language and one balance	The reason a non-crypto user can complete a task at all. One total on home, networks behind a tap, no tickers or chain names.	Redesign brief §2/§6; documented copy pass.
0.05% fee	Two orders of magnitude under remittance corridors and freelance platforms — provided the ramp story stays honest.	<code>PLATFORM_FEE_BPS</code> , gas excluded, recipient from env.
Honest status reporting	Under-rated: <code>STATUS.md</code> lists what is broken, including — money once stranded and recovered. That culture is why this report could be written in a day.	

7.2 Fix before anything new

1. **Notifications that reach a closed app.** Everything in this report — approval requests, "money arrived", "your buyer confirmed delivery", a hold about to expire — depends on reaching someone who isn't holding the phone. Pusher only works while the app is running or backgrounded. FCM/APNs is the gating dependency for the agent roadmap, not a polish item.
2. **Two-sided job escrow.** Today a job hold releases only on the payer's word and refunds to the payer at expiry. Add *delivered* → *auto-release after N days unless disputed*, a dispute state with attached evidence, and a decision rule that is written down before the first dispute rather than during it.
3. **No stranded money, ever.** Finish the abandoned-bridge completion rule (user window ~20 minutes, then the server completes and charges twice the gas it spent to the platform fee wallet), and either finish or hide the bridge and Gateway surfaces. A payments app may be slow; it may not lose track.

4. **Safe-send guardrails.** First-time-payee confirmation showing the resolved name, a cooling-off hold the sender can cancel, and a plain warning when paying a raw address. This is cheap and directly targets the fraud pattern regulators are now forcing banks to reimburse.
5. **Turn on the agent path or take it out of the UI.** An empty origin allowlist means paid execution is off; seed it with a curated list (Circle's Agent Marketplace), wire the two dead service functions or delete them.
6. **Assistant capacity.** ~8,000 tokens/minute is roughly three questions a minute across all users. Fine for one person, not for a demo with five. Cache, shrink turns, or budget for a paid tier before any launch.
7. **Production hygiene.** Normalise the Mongo snapshot before the 16 MB ceiling, move profile photos off local disk, plan for more than one instance, and get an external contract audit before real value. Also unblock the Flutter test run (the stale `Inter.ttf` reference) — a payments app with a red test suite is a liability.
8. **Decide the ramp question.** Nigeria's August 2026 framework makes cash-in/out a licensing decision with capital requirements attached. Wallet-to-wallet only is lighter, and less useful. Choose deliberately, with dates.

08 · BUILD

What to add

Each proposal names the problem it closes, how it is built from what already exists, and what the user sees. Customer-facing wording follows the project's copy rules — no chain, hold, escrow or protocol language.

8.1 For people

1 · "Paid ✓" — a receipt anyone can check closes H3

Every completed payment already produces a verified record. Publish it as a link and a QR code: who paid, how much, when, and a check anyone can run — no account required. Pair it with a **seller view** that lists money as it arrives, with a sound, so a vendor never has to squint at a customer's screenshot again.

Build: extends the existing public pages next to `/pay/{requestId}`. Days, not weeks. **User sees:** "Show this to the seller — they can check it themselves."

2 · Hold-until-delivered links closes H2

A seller creates a link in Evabob and pastes it into WhatsApp, Instagram or a bio. The buyer pays from anywhere — the money leaves their wallet, so the seller can see it is committed, but the seller cannot take it until the buyer confirms delivery or the window closes. If nothing happens, the money goes home automatically. Over time a seller accumulates a visible record of completed holds: reputation that is earned rather than claimed.

Build: `PaymentEscrowV2` with `purpose: "job"` plus a public page and a short expiry. **User sees:** "Your money is set aside for Ada until your order arrives." Never the word escrow.

3 · Safe send closes H1, H10

Three small things: confirm the resolved name and photo before a first payment to anyone; hold a first-time payment for ten minutes with a visible Cancel on the receipt; warn plainly when paying an address that has never been paid before. For the voice-clone pattern, offer an optional family check — a payment to a saved family member above a set amount asks for a second confirmation through a different channel.

4 · Work that pays itself out closes H8

Milestones on an invoice, automatic reminders on the due date, and — the important part — *delivered* → *releases in N days unless disputed*. A freelancer who has delivered should not depend on a client remembering to tap a button. Dispute opens a conversation with evidence attached, not a support ticket.

5 · Money circles and group pots closes H9

A circle where the contract holds the pot: fixed contribution, fixed payout order set at the start, automatic collection, and a progress view every member can see. The same machinery covers one-off group collections — a wedding, a funeral, class dues — with a target, a public progress bar, and automatic refunds if the target isn't met. Nobody holds the money, so nobody can leave with it.

6 · Tell people where their money is closes H4, H6

A status link for any payment the sender can share: *Sending* → *On the way* → *Done*, with the amount the recipient actually receives shown before sending, not after. 41% of remittance users get a different final amount than they expected;⁴¹ showing the landed amount up front is a differentiator that costs nothing.

8.2 For agents

7 · Agent allowance closes A1, A3

Reframe the agent wallet as an allowance with a shape people already understand: an amount, a window, and a list of what it may be spent on — "\$20 this week, research services only". Three tiers of approval: silent below the owner's own limit, a push approval above it, refusal beyond the cap. Plus a **live meter** and a **loop breaker** that pauses the agent when it calls the same endpoint repeatedly in a short window, which is exactly how every runaway bill in the developer post-mortems happened.²² One tap freezes everything.

Build: caps and reservations exist; this is the visible half — plus the FCM dependency in \$7.2.

8 · Pay after proof closes A4

For paid calls, hold rather than pay: release on a valid response, refund automatically when the seller fails or returns nothing usable. Attach an evidence bundle to each payment — what the owner authorised, what was asked, what came back, hashed and timestamped — exportable when a counterparty argues.¹⁴

9 · Agents with names, and reputations closes A7

Register agents in the identity registry as a new identity type appended at the end (never renumbering existing ordinals), so an agent can be paid by handle and its owner is always visible: "Research agent · owned by @ada". Seed the seller allowlist from a curated marketplace rather than leaving it empty, and record completion history the way human sellers accumulate it.

10 · An agent can hire a person — with the money locked first closes A6

An agent posts a task with the fee already locked. The human sees "the money is set aside before you start" and does the work; delivery releases it; nothing delivered returns it. This is the single clearest answer to a documented failure — 35 of 37 completed bounties unpaid²³ — and no card network can serve it, because the payer is not a person.

11 · Get paid by agents closes A10

A link that charges software for access to something a person made — a dataset, a photo set, an hour of their time, a small API. Evabob hosts the paywall, takes the payment, and deposits it. The individual's version of pay-per-crawl, for people who will never run a CDN.

12 · Let any assistant ask Evabob for money — safely closes A3, A5

An Evabob connector for external assistants: a third-party agent can raise a *payment request card* into the owner's Evabob chat, which the owner approves with a PIN exactly as they approve the in-app assistant's proposals today. The agent never holds spending authority; approval happens in Evabob, on the owner's device, where the limits live. It extends the one pattern in the product that already resists prompt injection.

Roadmap, metrics, risks

9.1 Order of work

HORIZON	SHIP	WHY NOW
Now ~6 weeks	Push notifications (FCM/APNs) · two-sided job escrow with auto-release · abandoned-bridge completion · safe-send guardrails · "Paid ✓" receipts and seller view	Four of these are defect-class problems that quietly break promises the product already makes. "Paid ✓" is the cheapest new thing with the widest daily use.
Next quarter	Hold-until-delivered links for chat commerce · agent allowance with tiers, meter and loop breaker · pay-after-proof with evidence bundles · curated seller list · milestones and reminders	The two flagship bets — one human, one agent — both built on the same contract, with the safety work already landed under them.
Later 6 months+	Money circles and group pots · agent-hires-human bounties · agents with handles · get-paid-by-agents links · external assistant connector · ramps and cards via licensed partners	Higher build cost or dependent on partners, licensing and the ramp decision. Sequenced after the core promise is unambiguous.

9.2 What to measure

- **Held-payment completion rate** — holds released on delivery vs expired and refunded. The single best proxy for whether trust is being manufactured.
- **Time to release** — how long a buyer or payer takes to confirm. If it drifts, auto-release is doing the work.
- **Dispute rate and outcome split** — the number that decides whether Evabob is a payments app or an arbitration business.
- **Receipt verifications by non-users** — how often a "Paid ✓" link is opened by someone without an account: the fake-alert thesis, measured.
- **Share of payments to a name vs a raw address** — identity coverage, and the wrong-address risk surface.
- **Agent spend vs cap utilisation, and loop-breaker trips** — whether the brakes are real.
- **Approval response time and approval rate** — an approval rate near 100% means rubber-stamping, not consent.
- **Stranded value** — money mid-flight over 20 minutes. Target zero, alarm at one.

9.3 Risks and open questions

RISK	ASSESSMENT
Becoming an arbitration business	The moment holds have disputes, someone decides them. Decide now whether that is time-based rules only (cheap, predictable, occasionally unfair) or human review (expensive, unbounded). Our recommendation: time and evidence rules only, with the bias documented in the interface.
Regulatory scope creep	Nigeria's consortium model plus ₦2bn/₦300m capital tiers and a 1.5% conversion stamp duty make ramps a licensing project, not a feature. ⁵² Wallet-to-wallet keeps Evabob lighter but less useful. This is a founder decision, not an engineering one.
On-chain memos are public forever	Already documented in the code, and correct. Arc mainnet now offers opt-in confidential transactions with view keys ¹ — worth evaluating before memos carry anything about real people.
Unsalted identity hashes	Email is low-entropy enough to brute-force, so the registry hash is not a privacy guarantee. A server-held pepper is possible without redeploying, at the cost of rewriting existing links. Decide before a real user base exists.
Agent-payment demand may be thinner than it looks	Half of x402 volume looks like testing, and the first consumer agent checkout retreated. ^{3,16} Mitigation: the agent work proposed here is mostly reuse of the human machinery, so a slow market costs little.
Scams follow the users	Any instrument that builds trust gets used to fake it — "hold" links will be advertised by sellers who then never deliver. Time-boxed windows, visible completion history and an easy report path need to ship with the feature, not after it.
Single-instance infrastructure and no audit	Process-global writer leases, a single Mongo snapshot document, and unaudited contracts are acceptable for testnet and not for value. Named here so the launch conversation cannot skip them.

The one-line version

Sending money is a commodity; **waiting for delivery is not**. Evabob already has the contract that waits, the identities that make waiting legible, and the capped wallets that let software participate. Ship the brakes and the receipts, put the hold where the commerce actually happens — in a chat thread and in an agent's task — and the human and agent halves of this product stop being two demos and become one argument.

10 · SOCIAL SIGNAL

In their own words

Section 2 said Reddit, X, Instagram and Facebook were closed to us. A second pass on 18 September found a partial way in. X and Facebook pages still won't open for our tools, but search engines index the text of public posts, and that text can be read. Everything quoted below is the post text exactly as the index shows it. X dates come from the post ID, which records when the post was made. Reddit stayed fully closed: the domain is excluded even from search results. Instagram gave us only reel titles, which were too thin to quote.

What this pass changed

- **No recommendation changes.** Every thread we found maps to a problem already in Sections 4 and 5. Several are older than the report's main sources, going back to 2022. That is the point: these problems are chronic.
- **One new fact, and it helps Evabob.** In September 2025 Circle's president told the Financial Times the company was looking at ways to reverse USDC transactions in cases of fraud, while keeping settlement final. On Arc, he said, this "would need to be a layer laid on top of the Arc network."^{S3, S4} Evabob's held-payment contract is already that kind of layer: undo without changing the chain. That supports the undo direction in H1 and Safe send (§8, item 3). It is also a reason to watch Circle, which could ship a reversal layer of its own.
- **Coding-agent users are hitting the approval problem first.** One post says approving every tool call "isn't the way". A thread promoting an agent's "smart approvals" describes the exact failure: the approval request lands while the owner sleeps, and the agent sits "stuck for 4 hours."^{S28, S29} Both match what this report recommends: approvals by risk level (A3) and notifications that reach a closed app (§7.2, item 1). This makes the notifications fix more urgent.
- **H2 is not only a Nigerian problem.** The same Instagram-vendor pattern appears in Kenya.^{S5} That matters for choosing a launch market.
- **Fake alerts now copy real brands.** Nigerian Facebook groups warn about an "Opay++" app that sends fake alerts.^{S9, S10} If the fake looks like the brand the seller already trusts, the seller can't spot it inside that app. A receipt anyone can check outside the payer's app (§8, item 1) fixes this.
- **With black tax, the frustration is about expectations, not giving.**^{S21} That fits purpose-bound family money: a fixed amount on a fixed schedule. It stays parked until cash-out exists, but the need is real.

10.1 People

PROBLEM	WHAT WAS POSTED	WHAT IT ADDS
H1	"Millions of consumers have been ripped off, but Zelle and the banks that run it have refused to stop the fraud or accept responsibility." X · @SenWarren, US senator · 2 Jan 2025 · S1 "A judge denied @Zelle's attempt to dismiss our lawsuit after they failed to protect users from rampant fraud." X · @NewYorkStateAG · 20 Jul 2026 · S2 "NEW: Circle is exploring reversible USDC transactions to recover funds lost in hacks and fraud, per FT." X · @Cointelegraph · 25 Sep 2025 · S3	Irreversibility is now a legal fight in the US, not just a complaint. And the company that issues USDC is openly weighing reversal (see above).

PROBLEM	WHAT WAS POSTED	WHAT IT ADDS
H2	<i>"Instagram Furniture Page Exposed After Buyer Loses Ksh 15,000 in Routine Online Scam"</i> X · @NyakundiReport, Kenya · 22 Apr 2026 · S5 <i>"Legit vendors on Instagram can't be more than 2. Everywhere scam!"</i> X · @Durbarmen, Nigeria · 4 Dec 2025 · S6 <i>"Scammed by an online vendor? Lawyer explains how to recover your money"</i> Facebook · Instablog9ja video · S7	Buyers now assume "scam until proven otherwise", and that punishes honest sellers too. A hold link is something an honest seller can offer as proof.
H3	<i>"Opay users is this a fake alert or a real alert"</i> X · @symplyDAPO · 15 Jan 2025 · S8 <i>"Warning about Opay++ app sending fake bank alerts in Nigeria"</i> Facebook group post · S9 <i>"Opay++ app sends fake bank alerts to receivers"</i> Facebook group post · S10 <i>"Do not rely on a screenshot as proof of payment, no matter ..."</i> Facebook · a New Zealand police district · S11	The fake-alert tool is named after a real fintech, so the alert looks right inside a brand the seller trusts. Police in New Zealand post the same warning, so this is not only a Nigerian problem.
H5	<i>"Hi @PayPal you have randomly banned my account today. No warning or explanation was provided. The notice states that you will hold my money for 180 days. No reply from customer support."</i> X · @iamtomnash · 23 Jan 2025 · S12 <i>"We used to struggle a lot with @PayPal withholding our money for up to 21 days."</i> X · @MattiSchroder · 28 Jun 2023 · S13	Confirms H5. The hold comes with "no warning or explanation", which is why H5 says to publish the freeze policy before it's needed.
H7	<i>"My Nigerian dollar card is not working for my Netflix and Aliexpress"</i> X · @Ifeagbeja · 26 Oct 2025 · S14 <i>"Which virtual debit card is working in Nigeria? Making international Dollar payment is very difficult. ... They take your money but you cannot use their so-called virtual card for payments."</i> X · @InibeheEffiong · 18 Jul 2023 · S15	The same complaint two years apart: this problem is chronic, not a one-off outage.
H8	<i>"For the last six months, I worked for LastHopium. And now after all the work is done my client has decided not to pay my last invoice ..."</i> X · @Noxx_Art · 27 Jun 2022 · S16	"After all the work is done" is exactly when today's job hold lets the worker down: it refunds the payer when it expires (\$7.2, item 2).
H9	<i>"FESTAC AJO WOMAN Has bucanized her contributors money and ran away into thin air"</i> Facebook post · S17 <i>"I heard another person ran away with over 30M of Ajo money"</i> Facebook post · S18 <i>"What to do when an Ajo collector refuses to pay back?"</i> Facebook group post · S19 <i>"If your ajo contributions still live on WhatsApp, maybe 2026 is ..."</i> Facebook video · S20 <i>"Most of the frustration isn't even about giving, it's about expectations. People back home often assume you can always do more."</i> X · @AskMichaelTaiwo · 15 Dec 2025 · S21	People post about ajo collectors vanishing all the time, and ajo groups already run on WhatsApp, where Evabob links would travel. With black tax, the pain is open-ended expectation, and a fixed schedule answers that.
H10	<i>"funds sent using an unsupported network cannot be recovered."</i> X · @CoinbaseSupport · 22 Jun 2025 · S22 <i>"Sent USDT BEP20 to Kraken's ERC20 address by mistake ... support says possible recovery but Reddit show others tickets W same problem open forever."</i> X · @TBDECRYPTO · 21 Nov 2025 · S23	Even the biggest exchanges tell users a wrong-network send "cannot be recovered". Sending to a name avoids this. Raw 0x sends to exchanges are where Evabob users would still be exposed.

10.2 Agents

PROBLEM	WHAT WAS POSTED	WHAT IT ADDS
A1	<i>"Jason Calacanis says his company hit \$300/day per agent using Claude's API at only 10-20% capacity, which scales to around \$100,000/year per agent."</i> X · @HedgieMarkets · 20 Feb 2026 · S24	Agent spend is already a budget line. People need a ceiling and a meter, not a surprise invoice.

A2

"You are genuinely insane if you let an AI agent anywhere near your personal or corporate information. Even more so if you give it access to your bank accounts, credit cards, passport ..."

X · @FinanceDirCFO · 12 Apr 2026 · S25

"Brit mathematician lets AI agent loose with credit card – cue password leaks, CAPTCHA chaos and more"

X · @TheRegister · 5 May 2026 · S26

"AI agents are everywhere at @Uber. ... the thing that keeps me up at night is how we are going to secure them. ... our agents run 50,000+ sessions per day across thousands of endpoints."

X · @praveenTweets · 1 Aug 2026 · S27

The objection is specific: "access to your bank accounts, credit cards". Evabob's answer is a separate wallet with a hard cap that never touches the main balance. Say it that plainly.

A3

"You should not let your coding agent run free without any checks but also approving each tool call isn't the way"

X · @reach_vb · 8 Jun 2026 · S28

"the agent hits a command that needs approval. you're asleep. the agent stops. waits. you wake up. it's been stuck for 4 hours."

X · YanXbt (@IBuzovskyi), a thread promoting "smart approvals" · 30 Jul 2026 · S29

Coding-agent users are running into approval fatigue and missed approvals now. Payment agents will be next. The report already has both fixes: approvals by risk level, and push notifications.

A6

"Rent A Human' has 500,000 people signed up for hire by autonomous bots to perform menial tasks. The platform takes no responsibility. Responsibility falls on the bots."

X · @maxkeiser · 18 Feb 2026 · S30

The liability gap in one line: when a bot is paying, nobody is responsible for paying the worker. Locking the fee before work starts fixes that.

11 · APPENDIX

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x.com/SenWarren/status/1874826599637635551

S2. X · @NewYorkStateAG, 20 Jul 2026.
x.com/NewYorkStateAG/status/2079333043630735453

S3. X · @Cointelegraph, 25 Sep 2025.
x.com/Cointelegraph/status/1971152809698406563

S4. Decrypt — *Circle Mulls Reversible USDC Stablecoin Transactions*, 25 Sep 2025. decrypt.co/341374 · CoinDesk — *Circle Examines Ways to Reverse Transactions to Counter Fraud, Disputes: FT*, 25 Sep 2025. coindesk.com/business/2025/09/25/circle-examines-ways-to-reverse-transactions-to-counter-fraud-disputes-ft

S5. X · @NyakundiReport, 22 Apr 2026.
x.com/NyakundiReport/status/2046986340479152466

S6. X · @Durbarman, 4 Dec 2025.
x.com/Durbarman/status/1996695204359700677

S7. Facebook · Instablog9ja video.
facebook.com/instablog9ja/videos/3550524201744840/

S8. X · @symplyDAPO, 15 Jan 2025.
x.com/symplyDAPO/status/1879641724311740530

S9. Facebook group post.
facebook.com/groups/710061626405035/posts/1963449427732909/

S10. Facebook group post.
facebook.com/groups/2605632532990184/posts/3950794068474017/

S11. Facebook · Manawatū–Taranaki–Whanganui–Ruapehu Police.
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S12. X · @iamtomnash, 23 Jan 2025.
x.com/iamtomnash/status/1882494749271368128

S13. X · @MattiSchroder, 28 Jun 2023.
x.com/MattiSchroder/status/1674087298307362816

S14. X · @Ifeagbeja, 26 Oct 2025.
x.com/Ifeagbeja/status/1982482983191011348

S15. X · @InibeheEffiong, 18 Jul 2023.
x.com/InibeheEffiong/status/1681322258021732352

S16. X · @Noxx_Art, 27 Jun 2022.
x.com/Noxx_Art/status/1541495965026246657

S17. Facebook post. facebook.com/kinsley.kissito/posts/8955604754548848/

S18. Facebook post. facebook.com/jantsah/posts/6657869697589337/

S19. Facebook group post.
facebook.com/groups/767894497693862/posts/1299036477912992/

S20. Facebook video. facebook.com/stephla.cutee/videos/2935021530021289/

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x.com/AskMichaelTaiwo/status/2000625746226598037

S22. X · @CoinbaseSupport, 22 Jun 2025.
x.com/CoinbaseSupport/status/1936927472055980411

S23. X · @TBDECRYPTO, 21 Nov 2025.
x.com/TBDECRYPTO/status/1991727873649176744

S24. X · @HedgieMarkets, 20 Feb 2026.
x.com/HedgieMarkets/status/2024837944880906608

S25. X · @FinanceDirCFO, 12 Apr 2026.
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S26. X · @TheRegister, 5 May 2026.
x.com/TheRegister/status/2051635588831580524

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x.com/maxkeiser/status/2024253545931796821